

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 4
♥ K 10 5 2
♦ A J 7 3
♣ J 5

♠ K 5
♥ A 6 4
♦ 9 6 2
♣ A K Q 6 3



♠ J 9
♥ Q J 9 7 3
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 7 4

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2
♥ 8
♦ K 10 5
♣ 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

You have an invitational strength hand with a 6-card Major suit. It's a no-brainer; you transfer with a 2♥ bid. Partner says 2♠;

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Repeat: You have an **invitational** strength hand with a **6-card** Major suit. So you invite with 3♠s. Partner accepts with 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by South.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q. Of course you take the ♥A.

Loser List: ♠ = 1/2/3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 ::
Total = 4/5/6

Missing 5 ♠s, the most likely split is 3-2, (68% of the time). You win the ♥A then play ♠K and ♠A, both defenders following to both leads but the ♠Q is still out there.

Do you play ♠s again or not?

Usually it is a good idea to leave a master trump un-pulled and go about your business winning tricks in other suits. The idea is to force them to ruff without using any more of your trumps. But that is only "usually". Here your big source of winners is going to be the ♣ suit - and there are zero outside entries to it. Suppose you do not force out the ♠Q, but start playing ♣ winners. A defender might ruff the third ♣ and you would be doomed.

So play one more ♠ and they are doomed.

Master trump outstanding: To pull or not to pull, that is the question.

Almost always the answer is "not to pull".

The big exception is when you have a running suit in one hand but with no outside entries to it. A hand exactly like this one.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 3
♥ K Q 9 7 4
♦ 7 6 4 2
♣ 10

♠ 10 7 5

♥ 6 3

♦ Q J 10 9

♣ J 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q

♥ A J 10

♦ A K 5 3

♣ A 8 7 3

♠ 9 8 6 4 2

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 8

♣ K Q 9 6

West	North	East	South
		2NT	Pass
3♦	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♠	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

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Check for Aces with Blackwood, partner replies 5♠. What next?

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Check for Aces with Blackwood, partner replies 5♠. What next?

Partner shows three Aces. You can't consider a Grand Slam, so bid 6♥.

The contract would be 6♥ played by West.

East plays 6♥. South leads the ♦8, on which North plays the ♦9. You win the ♦K.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

If you look just at the West and East hands you would think this was a pretty easy slam to make. Pull trumps and play three rounds of ♦s, and as long as the ♦s split 3-2 you make twelve tricks. But when you consider the ♦8 opening lead you realize that it won't happen. The missing ♦s are Q J 10 9 and 8. The ONLY combination from which South would lead the ♦8 is when he has a singleton. So the ♦s won't be splitting and you need a different plan.

You need to get a ♦ discard somewhere, and dummy's third ♠ will take care of one of **YOUR** ♦ losers. But then to establish **YOUR** hand you are going to have to ruff all 3 ♣ losers.

Play the ♣A and ruff a ♣. Enter your hand with the ♥10 and ruff another ♣ high. Back to your hand with the ♥J and ruff another ♣ high. Dummy is out of trumps but there is still one more in a defender's hand. So come to your hand with the ♠Q and pull the last trump, discarding a ♦ from dummy.

With all the trumps pulled cash dummy's 2 ♠s and your ♦A, then give up a ♦ at the last trick.

This isn't strictly a dummy-reversal since you actually used your own hand to pull trumps and dummy's trumps for ruffing.

However it's a "role reversal", you pulled trumps with the short-trump hand and took three ruffs in the long-trump hand.

But call it whatever you like, that's the way to make this Deal.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 5 2

♥ 9 7 2

♦ 8 3

♣ 8 6 5

♠ A 6

♥ A 6 5

♦ K 7 6 2

♣ K Q 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 4 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 2

♠ Q J 7

♥ K Q J 10

♦ A Q 5

♣ A J 4

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♠

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South